

Our First Action

At this point, we can see not only that we've connected the URL to our controller but also that Rails is pointing the way to our next step—namely, to tell Rails what to display. That's where views come in. Remember when we ran the script to create the new controller? That command added several files and a new directory to our application. That directory contains the template files for the controller's views. In our case, we created a controller named `say`, so the views will be in the `app/views/say` directory.

By default, Rails looks for templates in a file with the same name as the action it's handling. In our case, that means we need to edit a file called `hello.html.erb` in the `app/views/say` directory. (Why `html.erb`? We'll explain in a minute.) For now, let's put some basic HTML in there:

rails7/demo1/app/views/say/hello.html.erb

```
<h1>Hello from Rails!</h1>
```

Save the `hello.html.erb` file, and refresh your browser window. You should see it display our friendly greeting, as in the following screenshot.



In total, we've looked at two files in our Rails application tree. We looked at the controller, and we modified a template to display a page in the browser. These files live in standard locations in the Rails hierarchy: controllers go into `app/controllers`, and views go into subdirectories of `app/views`. You can see this structure in the diagram shown.